Spoken Tutorial on Building with AI

Module	AI Essentials
Episode	3. Introduction to APIs
Learning Objective	At the end of this tutorial learner will be able to 1. Define what an API is. 2. Explain the purpose of an API key. 3. Identify components of an API request. 4. Apply the concept of API to real-world applications.
Approx. Duration	3-4 min
Outline	• What is an API? • Understanding API Keys • Anatomy of an API Request • Real-world API Application
Meta Tags	API, API Key, API Request, AI, Building with AI, Spoken Tutorial, Programming, Integration, Software Development, Authentication, Prompting
Pre-requisite Tutorial	Episode 2: Art of the Prompt

Script

Visual Cue	Narration
Title Slide	Welcome to this Spoken Tutorial on Building with **AI**.
Learning Objectives Slide	In this tutorial, you will learn to, • Define what an **API** is. • Explain the purpose of an **API key**. • Identify components of an **API request**. • Apply the concept of **API** to real-world applications.
System Requirements Slide	Here I am using a browser on a computer or mobile.
Pre-requisite Slide	To follow this tutorial, you should have completed Episode 2: Art of the **Prompt**.
Illustration of a waiter taking an order from a customer and bringing food from a kitchen	Have you ever wondered how different software talks to each other? An **API** acts like a messenger. It takes your request and tells a system what you want to do. Then, it brings back the response to you. Think of an **API** like a waiter at a restaurant. You give your order to the waiter. The waiter takes it to the kitchen, which is like an **AI** model. Then, the waiter brings your food back to you. The **API** delivers the **AI** output.

Illustration of a person showing an ID card to a waiter at a restaurant	Now, how does the system know it's you making the request? This is where an **API key** comes in. An **API key** is like your secret password or token. It identifies you as an authorized user. Imagine showing your ID card to order food at a restaurant. The **API key** ensures only legitimate requests are processed. It verifies that your request comes from a trusted source. This protects the **AI** model from unauthorized access.
Illustration of a person placing an order with a waiter	With your **API key** ready, you can now make an **API request**. An **API request** is simply sending information to the **AI** model. You send it through the **API**. This request includes your **API key** for authentication. It also contains your specific instruction or **prompt**. Think of this as placing your order with the waiter. The **API** transmits this request to the **AI** model. The model processes your instruction. Then, it sends back the desired output to you.
Illustration of a person using a food delivery app on a smartphone	Let's see how **API** works in a real-world app. Imagine you open a food delivery app on your phone. You browse the menu and place an order. The app does not directly talk to the restaurant. Instead, it sends an **API request** to the delivery platform's server. This request has your order details and your **API key**. The delivery platform's server then uses another **API**. It communicates with the restaurant's system. It relays your order to the restaurant. It also receives status updates, like 'Order accepted.' All this happens smoothly behind the scenes, thanks to **APIs**.
Summary Slide	Let us summarize what we learned. We defined **APIs** as digital messengers. We understood **API keys** as identification for access. We learned that an **API request** is like placing an order. We also saw how **APIs** power apps like food delivery.
Assignment Slide	Now as an assignment, Think of another everyday application. Describe how an **API** might work behind the scenes. Share your example with a friend or colleague. Compare the results.

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